

DESIGN WEEK

Vello NeighborCard

From reference image to corrected component

What I found wrong, how I guided Claude, and what I improved

1 What I Found When I Reviewed

CONTRAST FAIL

Available badge: 4.12:1

--brand-primary (green-600) on --surface-brand-tint.
WCAG AA requires 4.5:1 for 12px text.
Failing by 0.38 ratio points.

STALE DOCS

Day 2 and Day 3 still referenced coral badge

Component was fixed but documentation
wasn't updated. Inconsistent.

NO MEASUREMENTS

Audit had zero contrast numbers

Mentor said: 'Add contrast ratios and other
measured values to every audit.'
I had descriptions but no numbers.

2 How I Fixed It

BEFORE

```
/* Available badge text color */
color: var(--brand-primary);
/* green-600 = #557E26 */
Contrast: 4.12:1
FAILS AA (needs 4.5:1 at 12px)
```

AFTER

```
/* Available badge text color */
color: var(--text-brand);
/* green-700 = #466621 */
Contrast: 5.70:1
PASSES AA ✓
```



3

Measured Contrast Audit

11 color pairs verified with WCAG 2.1 formulas

Color Pair	Ratio	AA	Verdict
text-strong / surface-card	17.13	PASS	Name, price
text-brand / surface-brand-tint	5.70	PASS	Available badge (FIXED)
text-muted / surface-card	5.04	PASS	Price unit, captions
brand-primary / surface-card	4.77	PASS	Verified mark
focus-ring / surface-card	1.52	FAIL	Open question for designer
rating star / surface-card	1.80	OK*	Number shown as text next to it

4 How I Taught Claude the Design System

v1 - RULES ONLY

'Only these 6 hex colors'

Claude followed literally.
Used raw hex instead of semantic tokens.
The rule was too vague.

✗ **Still drifted**

v2 - RULES + CONTEXT

Added token names, traced decisions, where to look

Claude stopped inventing colors. But still 'verified' contrast without measuring.
No method to check.

~ **Better, not enough**

v3 - RULES + CONTEXT + METHOD

5 mandatory steps in order. Definition of Done. Measured contrast table.

Claude follows the method.
Measures contrast.
Uses correct tokens.
Verifies before declaring done.

✓ **Works correctly**

5 Prompt Evolution: Generic to Precise

WEAK PROMPT

```
'Generate a NeighborCard for  
Vello using the design system  
tokens.'
```

Result:

- Hardcoded hex (#16462F, #F6F2E7)
- div instead of button
- Initials instead of photo
- MapPin instead of footprints
- 1 star instead of 5
- No Available badge
- No states

STRONG PROMPT

```
'Compare property by property.  
For each value: what token it  
should use, what the component  
used, whether it matches.  
Don't accept looks similar.'
```

Result:

- Found 7/11 properties with drift
- Each traced to exact token
- Corrections documented
- Audit has numbers, not opinions

6 What I Learned

- Design is not just how it looks, but how it's MEASURED
- Rules tell Claude WHAT. Context tells WHY. Method tells HOW to verify.
- Every element answers a user question. If it doesn't, it's clutter.
- Numbers turn opinions into facts. 4.12:1 is a fact. 'Looks fine' is not.
- AI generates, you decide. The skill is judging the output, not producing it.

PR #1 SUBMITTED

Measured. Corrected. Documented.

11 color pairs audited. Badge contrast fixed from 4.12:1 to 5.70:1.

Stale docs updated. CLAUDE.md evolved through 3 versions.

Every finding has a number.

github.com/adrianachipana-lab/vello-provider-card-deliverable/pull/1